Steven Mendez

PRODUCT SOFTWARE ENGINEER

CONTACT

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Open to work · Remote · US hours

CORE STACK

Engineering

Python	EXPERT
TypeScript	EXPERT
React	EXPERT
FastAPI	EXPERT
Next.js	EXPERIENCED
PostgreSQL	EXPERIENCED
Supabase	EXPERIENCED

AI / LLM

Claude API	EXPERT
Claude Code	EXPERT
MCP Servers	EXPERT
Prompt Eng.	EXPERT
Agentic Workflows	EXPERIENCED
RAG Systems	EXPERIENCED

Payments & Infra

Stripe Connect	EXPERT
Stripe Checkout	EXPERT
ONVO	EXPERIENCED

LANGUAGES

Spanish	Native
English	Professional

Product Software Engineer

AI-Native Architecture · Multi-Product Ownership · 0 → Production at Scale

PROFILE

I design and ship complete products — from raw idea to revenue-ready system. My work spans AI-native architecture, end-to-end product engineering, and the discipline of hardening systems before they touch real users.

AI isn't a tool in my workflow — it's a collaborator. Claude and modern LLMs let me think deeper, observe problems more clearly, and execute faster without sacrificing rigor. *The bottleneck in modern software isn't writing code. It's clarity: how deep you look before building, and what you choose not to ship.*

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer · Lead Developer

Dec 2025 — Oct 2026

Dojo Coding Labs

Remote · Costa Rica

Built the **AI layer of DOJO** (trydojo.io) and was core product engineer across **three production platforms**: DOJO (talent platform used in 8 countries), MenteFut (AI mental coaching for athletes) and Hikari (B2B institutional platform). Owner of the Dojo Projects pillar — zero to production V1 with a single PR of +80K LOC, plus 16 follow-up PRs of post-V1 hardening across 1,400+ files. 1,000+ merged PRs.

- **Doji, the AI agent** — OpenClaw gateway plugin with five personas behind a router on Gemini 2.5 Flash and Pro, and 9 tools: semantic search over 4 pgvector domains, read-only SQL with RLS, a 100-point developer match, a 3-phase project intake, Dojo Score and memory. Generative UI: it answers with live components.
- **WhatsApp agent & guardrails** — Doji on the WhatsApp Business API (voice notes, guest mode, account linking, sign-up from the chat), with PII-leak detection, prompt-injection blocking, an audit log of every tool call and an LLM judge.
- **CRM + MCP connector** — The company CRM, fed by signature-verified Meta and WhatsApp webhooks, run from Claude by the ops team through an OAuth-secured MCP server.
- **Dojo Projects pillar (owner)** — Notarial-grade marketplace: Stripe Connect escrow, dual-signature attestations, milestone gates, dispute resolution, score-gated access. 11 pgTAP RLS suites passing.
- **Architecture & security** — Three-layer API (circuit breaker · TanStack Query hooks · query-key factory), the Dojo Design System and 31 pentest-derived security rules (JWT validation, SSRF prevention, anti-IDOR).
- **Growth & performance** — Triple-system funnel attribution (Meta CAPI + GA4 + PostHog), PKCE auth, Dojo Score redesign, 62% LCP improvement on Quantathon mobile.

SHIPPED (PUBLIC)

→trydojo.io — DOJO, Doji and Pathways (i18n EN/ES)
→trydojo.io/projects — Projects pillar marketplace
→SWE-201 — Software Engineering Fundamentals, the course I teach
→mentefutbol.com — Football Camp + Admin Dashboard + Embedded Checkout
→Hikari — B2B institutional platform (scaffold to v1.0-beta in 3 days)

STACK React 19 · TypeScript · Next.js · Vite · Supabase (Postgres + RLS + RPC + Edge Functions) · Gemini 2.5 · OpenClaw · MCP · pgvector · WhatsApp Business API · Stripe Connect · Mux · Langfuse · PostHog

SELECTED STACK

Claude API · Claude Code · MCP Servers · RAG Systems · Gemini · pgvector · Stripe Connect · Supabase · FastAPI · Next.js · React Query · WhatsApp API

MANIFESTO

> *Ship the system, not the snippet.*

> *Hardening before users.*

> *Clarity is the bottleneck.*

EXPERIENCE (CONT.)

Freelance Product Engineer

2022 — Present

Self-employed

Remote · Costa Rica

- **Restaurant POS + e-invoicing** — Costa Rica electronic invoicing (Hacienda), running every day in 3 restaurants, Sunset Café among them: signed XML, several issuers per tablet, atomic invoice numbers in Postgres, offline tablets and an MCP server for Claude.
- **Darlope Travels** — Booking system and CRM for a private-transfer company (darlopetravels.com): bookings from Liberia airport, live driver tracking for the owner, office and 5 drivers, leads by channel, ONVO payments.
- **DIESSA OS & Rusz Shop** — Leading a 3-person team on water telemetry for rural aqueducts (demo), and a sneaker store with ONVO checkout (ruszshop.com).

STACK React · React Router · Next.js · Supabase · Hono · MCP · OAuth 2.1 · ONVO

Full-Stack AI Developer

2024

UnchAIned

Remote · Contract

AI marketing startup. Built pipelines with OpenAI GPT-4, Claude Sonnet and DALL·E that turned structured JSON into text, image and video assets for Honda and Disney.

STACK Python · FastAPI · React · Next.js · OpenAI API · Claude API · DALL·E

Full-Stack Developer

2023

QSoft Costa Rica

Remote · Contract

Android warehouse app in Python with barcode and QR scanning for traceable production.

CERTIFICATIONS

ANTHROPIC · MAR 2026 VERIFY ↗
Building with the Claude API

ANTHROPIC · MAR 2026 VERIFY ↗
Claude Code in Action

ANTHROPIC · MAR 2026 VERIFY ↗
Introduction to Agent Skills

UDEMY · BOOTCAMP 2025 VERIFY ↗
Generative AI, LLM Apps & AI Agents

UDEMY VERIFY ↗
The Complete Full-Stack Web Development Bootcamp

UDEMY VERIFY ↗
100 Days of Code: Python Pro Bootcamp

IBM · COURSERA VERIFY ↗
Introduction to Software Engineering

IBM · COURSERA VERIFY ↗
Introduction to Cloud Computing

GOOGLE · COURSERA VERIFY ↗
Foundations of Data Science

GOOGLE · COURSERA VERIFY ↗
Get Started with Python

GOOGLE · COURSERA VERIFY ↗
Go Beyond the Numbers: Translate Data into Insights

UDEMY VERIFY ↗
Curso Completo de Python: Programación desde Cero

UDEMY VERIFY ↗
The Ultimate Beginners Course for CS / IT